T05 # Configuration Hierarchy

Technical Beginner

Where to configure what, from global to local

Configuration levels

Level	File	Scope	Git
Global user	~/.claude/settings.json	All projects	No
Global rules	~/.claude/CLAUDE.md	All projects	No
Shared project	.claude/settings.json	Team	Yes
Local project	.claude/settings.local.json	Personal	No
Project rules	CLAUDE.md (root)	Team	Yes
Subfolder	subfolder/CLAUDE.md	Folder	Yes

Conflict resolution

```
~/.claude/CLAUDE.md        (1 - global base)
↓ + merge
./CLAUDE.md                (2 - project rules)
↓ + merge
subfolder/CLAUDE.md        (3 - local rules)
↓ + merge
@explicit import           (4 - inline import)
```

Rules at a lower level **supplement** rather than replace higher levels.

settings.json: Structure

```
{
  "model": "claude-sonnet-5-5",
  "permissions": {
    "allow": ["Bash(git *)"],
    "deny": ["Bash(rm -rf*)"]
  },
  "env": {
    "DISABLE_TELEMETRY": "1"
  }
}
```

CLAUDE.md: Best practices

```
# Project Conventions

## Stack
- TypeScript strict mode
- pnpm (not npm)
- Tests: Vitest

## Rules
- Always check types before modifying
- Commits in English
- Never modify package-lock.json
```

What goes where

Global CLAUDE.md: personal preferences, code style, universal conventions.

Project CLAUDE.md: architecture, stack, team conventions, build/test commands.

Project settings.json: tool permissions, default model, dev environment variables.

settings.local.json: personal overrides that should not affect the team.

Required .gitignore

```
# In the project .gitignore
.claude/settings.local.json
```